

The Client *Desk*

User guide for the solo business command center:
clients, pipeline, invoices, reminders and your weekly
review in one spreadsheet.

- Works in Excel, Google Sheets & LibreOffice
- Automatic due dates & reminder stages A-E
- Dashboard of next actions and overdue invoices
- Admin audit with priority scoring
- Tested formulas, sample data included



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Welcome to The Client Desk

The **Client Desk** is a single spreadsheet that runs the admin side of a one-person service business: clients and pipeline, projects, invoices, payment reminders, your admin audit, your prompt and SOP libraries, and a weekly review. It's the tracker that goes with *The Solo Admin Playbook*, but it works on its own too.

What's inside

Tab	What it does
Start Here	Setup steps and the color key
Dashboard	Everything that needs attention, calculated from the other tabs
Clients & Pipeline	One row per client or lead: stage, value, next action and date
Projects	Milestones, deposits and your weekly-update day
Invoices & Follow-ups	Due dates, status, days overdue and the next reminder stage (A–E)
Admin Audit	Your recurring admin tasks, scored and ranked by priority
Prompt Log	The AI prompts you actually use (IDs match the Band of One Prompt Library)
SOP Library	An index of your procedures and when each needs a review
Weekly Review	The 45-minute agenda, live numbers, and a weekly log
Settings	Business name, payment terms, currency label, dropdown lists and reminder timing

The Client Desk

Dashboard for Sam Rivera Design (sample) - as of 24 Sep 2026

Active clients	Weighted pipeline (USD)	Outstanding (USD)	Overdue (USD)	Reminders to send
2	3,590	5,180	1,830	4
Follow-ups overdue	Follow-ups this week	Invoiced this month (USD)	Collected this month (USD)	Admin hours / month
1	4	4,650	100	23.3

Next client actions

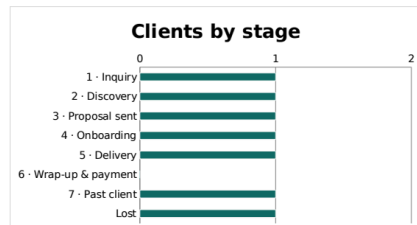
Client	Next action	Date	Status
Brightside Physio	Send call summary	2026-09-23	Overdue
Cedar Yoga	Reply to inquiry	2026-09-24	Due this week
Harbor Dental Studio	Send weekly update	2026-09-26	Due this week
Oak & Pine Law	Proposal follow-up (day 2)	2026-09-26	Due this week
Northfield Accounting	Kickoff call prep	2026-09-29	Due this week
Maple Street Bakery	90-day check-in email	2026-10-04	Upcoming

Invoices needing a reminder

Client	Invoice #	Balance	Action
Maple Street Bakery	2026-019	450.00	Send E now
Harbor Dental Studio	2026-023	180.00	Send D now
Oak & Pine Law	2026-021	600.00	Send B now
Northfield Accounting	2026-020	2,600.00	Send A now

Top admin tasks to fix first

Task	Minutes / month	Priority	Decision
Weekly client updates	320	960	Template
Social media posts	240	480	AI draft
Replying to inquiries	120	360	Template



Clients by stage

Stage	Clients	Value
1 - Inquiry	1	400
2 - Discovery	1	1,200
3 - Proposal sent	1	6,500
4 - Onboarding	1	5,200
5 - Delivery	1	4,800
6 - Wrap-up & payment	0	0
7 - Past client	1	3,900
Lost	1	3,000

Tip: sort or filter the other tabs any time. The dashboard reads the whole range.

The color key

- Yellow cells: type here.
- Grey cells: calculated. Don't type over them.
- Slate-colored headers: helper columns the Dashboard needs. Leave them in place.

Quick start (10 minutes)

1. Open the file

App	How
Microsoft Excel (2010 or later, Windows or Mac)	Double-click the <code>.xlsx</code> file. If Excel shows "Protected View", click Enable Editing .
Google Sheets	Go to Google Drive → New → File upload → choose the file → open it → File → Save as Google Sheets . Work in the Google Sheets copy.
LibreOffice Calc	Open the file normally.
Apple Numbers	Not tested. We recommend Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice (all free options exist).

TESTED

Every formula was recalculated in LibreOffice and checked against hand-calculated expected values with an automated test (over 60 checks) before release. The workbook uses only widely supported functions (INDEX, MATCH, COUNTIFS, SUMIFS, RANK and so on) so it behaves the same in Excel and Google Sheets.

2. Settings

Open **Settings** and fill in:

- **Your business name**, shown on the Dashboard.
- **Default payment terms (days)**, used when an invoice's own terms cell is blank.
- **Currency code**, used as a label on the Dashboard (e.g., USD, GBP, EUR).
- **Weekly review day**.
- **Services list**, which feeds the Service dropdown on the Clients tab.

Leave **Today override** blank. The workbook then uses your computer's date.

3. Clear the sample business

The file comes with a fictional sample business so you can see how everything works. Every sample row says **SAMPLE** in its Notes column. To remove it:

1. On each tab, select the **yellow** cells of the sample rows.
2. Press **Delete** (or Backspace in Google Sheets).

Don't delete whole rows. That removes the formulas in the grey cells. If it happens anyway, see *Troubleshooting*.

WHY THE SAMPLE DATES ALWAYS LOOK CURRENT

Sample dates are formulas based on "today", so the demo always looks realistic. When you type your own dates, they replace those formulas.

4. Add your first client and invoice

- **Clients & Pipeline:** type the client name, choose a **Stage**, and always fill in **Next action** and **Next action date**. The Dashboard lists your next eight actions in date order.
- **Invoices & Follow-ups:** type the invoice number, pick the client, and enter the **Issue date** and **Amount**. Due date, status, days overdue and the reminder stage appear automatically.

That's it. Open the **Dashboard**.

Tab by tab

Dashboard

Tile or section	Calculated from
Active clients	Clients in stages 4–6 (Onboarding, Delivery, Wrap-up)
Weighted pipeline	Project value × win % for stages 1–3 (the win % is an editable assumption on Settings)
Outstanding / Overdue	Unpaid invoice balances; overdue = past the due date
Reminders to send	Invoices where the current reminder stage is later than the last one you sent
Follow-ups overdue / this week	Client next-action dates before today / within 7 days
Invoiced / Collected this month	Invoice amounts by issue date; payments by paid date
Admin hours / month	Total from the Admin Audit
Next client actions	The 8 earliest next-action dates (excluding Lost clients)
Invoices needing a reminder	The 8 oldest invoices with a reminder due
Top admin tasks to fix first	The 3 highest priority scores from the Admin Audit
Clients by stage	Count and value per stage, with a chart

Clients & Pipeline

Stages: 1 Inquiry → 2 Discovery → 3 Proposal sent → 4 Onboarding → 5 Delivery → 6 Wrap-up & payment → 7 Past client (or Lost).

- **Group** is calculated: Pipeline (1–3), Active (4–6), Closed (7 and Lost).
- **Action status** is *Overdue* (date passed), *Due this week* (within 7 days) or *Upcoming*.
- **90-day check-in:** when a client moves to 7 · *Past client* and you enter a **Project end date**, the check-in date appears automatically. Put "90-day check-in" as the next action so it shows on the Dashboard.

Projects

Use one row per project. Enter the fee and deposit % and the deposit amount calculates. **Days to milestone** and the **Flag** column (Overdue / This week) help you plan. **Weekly update day** is a reminder of when each client expects their update (see Playbook Chapter 8).

Invoices & Follow-ups

The reminder system follows the five-stage cadence from *The Solo Admin Playbook* (Chapter 9):

Stage	Triggers (default)	Meaning
A	3 days before the due date	Friendly heads-up
B	On the due date	"Due today"
C	7 days overdue	Gentle nudge
D	14 days overdue	Firm follow-up, offer a plan
E	30 days overdue	Final notice (per your agreement)

How the Action column works: the workbook works out which stage is due *today*. If you haven't logged that stage in **Last reminder sent**, the Action column says **"Send C now"** (for example). After you send it, choose **C** in *Last reminder sent* and enter the date; the action changes to **"Up to date"** until the next stage is due. **Next reminder date** tells you when that will be.

Part payments: enter what's been paid in **Amount paid**. The balance and status update (*Part-paid* while not yet due).

Paid: when **Amount paid** equals the amount, the status becomes **Paid** and reminders stop.

Admin Audit

List every recurring admin task, then score it:

- **Repeatability:** 3 = nearly identical every time · 2 = similar · 1 = different every time.
- **Risk:** 1 = low stakes · 2 = money, client data or deadlines · 3 = legal, sensitive or relationship-critical.

Priority score = (times per month × minutes each) × repeatability ÷ risk. Rank 1 is where to start. Choose a **Decision** (Eliminate, Template, AI draft, Automate, Keep human) and note the prompt or template you'll use.

Measuring savings honestly: after you've changed how you do a task for a couple of weeks, re-estimate its minutes in **Minutes / month after**. Only then does the workbook show time saved. It

never assumes a saving.

Prompt Log

The 17 core prompts from the Playbook are pre-listed. Record where you saved each one, how often you use it, and your rating. The full set of 100 prompts is in *The Band of One Prompt Library* (sold separately); add any you use here.

SOP Library

List each procedure, where it lives, when you last reviewed it and how often it should be reviewed (default 90 days). **Status** shows *Not written yet*, *OK* or *Review due*.

Weekly Review

The agenda sits at the top. **Live numbers** (overdue invoices, reminders to send, follow-ups due) are calculated for you. Copy them into a new log row each week, add your estimate of admin hours, and note one improvement you made. After a few weeks, the log shows whether your system is working.

Your weekly routine (15 minutes of the 45)

1. Open **Dashboard**.
2. **Next client actions:** send each follow-up (templates in the Playbook), then update that client's next action and date.
3. **Invoices needing a reminder:** send the stage shown (A–E), then log it in *Last reminder sent* and *Last reminder date*.
4. Record any payments (**Amount paid, Paid date**).
5. **Weekly Review** tab: copy the live numbers into a new log row.

Customizing

You want to...	Do this
Rename stages	Edit the text in Settings → Client stages . Keep eight stages; the group (Pipeline/Active/Closed) comes from the column beside it.
Change win % assumptions	Edit Settings → Win probability .
Change reminder timing	Edit Settings → Days from due date (e.g., make C = 10).
Add services or lead sources	Type them into the Settings lists (blank rows are provided for services).
Show a currency symbol	Select the money columns → Format → Number → Currency.
Add more rows	Select the last filled row, copy it, paste it into the rows below, then clear the yellow cells.
Use a different date format	Select the date columns → Format → Number → Date and pick your preferred format.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

A grey cell shows a formula error or went blank after I typed in it. You typed over a formula. Copy the grey cell from the row above (Ctrl/Cmd + C) and paste it into the broken cell. Formulas adjust automatically.

Dates show as numbers (e.g., 46310). Select the column → Format → Number → Date.

The dropdowns don't appear in Google Sheets. Make sure you're working in the converted Google Sheets copy (File → Save as Google Sheets), not the uploaded .xlsx preview.

The Dashboard's "as of" date is wrong. Check **Settings → Today override**. It should be blank for normal use.

Can I sort or filter the tabs? Yes. Filters are switched on for the main tables. Sorting whole rows is fine because each row's formulas refer to that row.

Is this accounting software? No. It's an organizer. Keep official financial records in the tools your accountant recommends, and follow your local invoicing requirements.

Where is my data stored? Only where you save the file: your computer or your own cloud drive. The workbook doesn't connect to anything.

License and support

Personal business license: the purchaser may use The Client Desk in their own business and adapt it freely for that business. You may not resell, share or redistribute the file, or pass it off as your own product. Full terms are in `LICENSE.txt`.

Updates: version 1.x updates are free through the store where you bought it.

Support: use the contact details on your purchase receipt or the product page. Please include which app you're using (Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice) and a screenshot of the issue with client details hidden.

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